

HTC to be PS certified

Some HTC phones are expected to get the PlayStation certification this year <http://bit.ly/xnQuqt>

Nothing beats streaming

After acquiring a stake in headphone maker Beats Audio, HTC will start a music streaming service

No iPhone = No Siri? Not really!

Third-party Android alternatives to Siri

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The iPhone 4S allure lies in its full-time “intelligent” assistant at your beck and call. At its price though, an iPhone 4S isn't within the budget of the majority of us. This made us wonder – can we get something similar for our Android phones? A bit of research later, we downloaded a whole bunch of third-party Siri clones from the Android Market. We've shortlisted three of the best. We asked each app the same question and got varied responses.

Iris.

Developer: Dextra

Price: Free

This is by far the most talkative



of all these clones, and gives the wittiest answers. You can ask Iris a general question, get it to call someone from the phonebook, play a song from

your phone's library etc. The app is still in the alpha stage, but at the current speed and precision of development, it just may be Android's answer to Apple's assistant.

Andy

Developer: 74

Technologies

Price: Free

Voice recognition is something that's going for this app in a big way. We didn't have any issues with regards to accent or ambient noise for the most part, and Andy's aura of seriousness when interacting is noteworthy. At first run, the app downloads a couple of 4GB worth add-ons, for which we suggest using Wi-Fi. While Iris has a humorous side to it, Andy keeps it very simple.

Alice

Developer: YourApp24

Price: Free

Alice works as well as Iris and Andy, and is yet another alternative, even if only for some fun. Again, this app seems to have better voice recognition than the original assistant on the block, Siri! Some answers seem to cross the border of being funny, deep into the “What the hell!” category! However, Alice is plenty of fun to use. Must download, more so because it's free.

Surprisingly or not-so-surprisingly, when we think about it, all the slaves...umm, we mean friendly personal assistants on Android have better voice recognition than Siri. Android apps use Google's very precise built-in speech recognition. **d**

Windows Phone Apollo – landing soon

But will it take Windows' smartphones (or superphones) to the next level, particularly in the app ecosystem?

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Yes, yet another leak, this time detailing the complete feature-set of Microsoft's next smartphone OS – Windows Phone 8, codenamed “Apollo”.

Wider hardware compatibility

As expected, Windows Phone 8 will bring in support for multi-

core processors, allowing for a wider range of smartphones to fill the market – that means more dual and quad core processor powered smartphones for sure. Essentially, Microsoft is looking at the upcoming “superphone” segment (expected later in 2012). Though there's no solid definition for the superphone, devices that will be based on Qualcomm's A15 architecture and sporting HD displays fall into this category. While the exact

numbers haven't been specified, the new OS will support four different display resolutions. Expect a host of display sizes with varied resolutions. To be at par with Android and iOS on the spec sheet, Near Field Communication (NFC) will also be supported. Tap-to-share capabilities will allow sharing with multiple platforms, allowing desktops, tablets and other smartphones to share content with ease.

**We think**

This brings WP 8 on par with Android and iOS in terms of hardware compatibility. As for the superphone bit, WP 8 does nothing earth shattering – there'll be similar phones on Android. And who knows what the iPhone 5 will be like?

Applications and OS features

Windows 8 Phone will have a lot in common with Windows 8